From awareness to action

Eczema is one of the most common yet often misunderstood skin disorders, affecting millions of people across all age groups. Atopic dermatitis, with an estimated incidence of around 11% in India, represents a substantial public health concern. Importantly, atopic dermatitis is primarily a disease of childhood, with the majority of cases beginning in infancy or early childhood. India is home to nearly 450 million children, almost one-third of its population. This means that close to 50 million children across the country could be living with atopic dermatitis, making it one of the most common chronic childhood skin conditions.

Recognizing the need for a dedicated platform to address the growing burden of eczema in India, the Society for Eczema Studies (SES) was established on 29 March 2022 under the visionary leadership of Dr Sandipan Dhar, internationally acknowledged as one of India's foremost authorities on atopic dermatitis. As the first organization of its kind in India and the Indian subcontinent, SES is committed exclusively to advancing the understanding, prevention, diagnosis, and management of all forms of eczema, including atopic dermatitis, contact dermatitis, occupational dermatitis, and related conditions. Beyond clinical management, the society also focuses on associated challenges such as chronic itch, patient advocacy, education, and improving quality of life.

Inspired by a shared passion for scientific excellence and collaborative learning, SES has laid out a broad roadmap to advance eczema care nationwide. The society organizes regular National Conferences, Continuing Medical Education (CME) programmes, workshops, quizzes, mentorship programmes and specialized training programmes to update the healthcare professionals with the latest evidence based knowledge.

Research remains a cornerstone of SES's mission. The society is working to generate India-specific data on the prevalence, treatment patterns, and outcomes of eczema through registries and questionnaire-based studies. It also promotes high-quality clinical, genetic, and molecular research, encourages publication in reputed national and international journals, and plans to introduce dedicated fellowship programmes in eczema in collaboration with leading academic organizations like International Eczema Council (IEC) and Skin Inflammation & Psoriasis International Network (SPIN).



SES welcomes life membership from dermatologists, pediatricians, pulmonologists, and internists (Degree, Diploma or DNB) registered with their respective State Medical Councils. Specialists from other disciplines may join as Associate Members, while postgraduate students in these specialties are eligible to enrol as Provisional Life Members (PLMs) for a period of five years, fostering the next generation of clinicians and researchers.

To commemorate World Eczema Day on 14 September, SES in collaboration with International Society of Pediatric Dermatology, has planned a series of nationwide awareness initiatives. These include a virtual patient awareness programme featuring leading dermatologists from across India including Dr Deepika Pandhi, Dr Dipankar De, Dr Maitreyee Panda, Dr Sahana P. Raju, Dr Safia Bashir, Dr Akash Agarwal and other experts, who will interact with patients living with severe eczema as well as those who have successfully overcome the disease. A live patient-doctor interaction at the Institute of Child Health, Kolkata, led by Dr Sandipan Dhar along with Dr Raghubir Banerjee, Dr Rajib Malakar and Dr Abhijit Saha will further strengthen patient engagement. Through education, research, advocacy, and compassionate patient engagement, the Society for Eczema Studies continues to strengthen India's response to eczema, bringing hope to patients and setting new benchmarks in dermatological care.

